For example, consider an agent tasked with retrieving information from a protected directory. If the agent attempts to read a file outside its authorized scope, the PEP blocks the request and returns a denial. The agent then revises its plan, perhaps selecting a different data source or narrowing its query.

This interaction creates a feedback loop:

1. The agent proposes an action.
2. The policy system evaluates the action.
3. The result influences the agent's next step.

Authorization decisions, therefore, serve as signals that guide the agent's behavior, not merely controls that block it.

18.3.2 Defining operational boundaries with policy

The policies that govern agent behavior are often straightforward. Some restrict which actions the agent can perform, while others limit the resources it can access.

For example, ACME allows agents to work with customer documents but restricts access to those owned by the customer associated with the current task:

```
permit (
    principal,
    action in [
        Action::"documents.search",
        Action::"documents.read",
        Action::"documents.summarize"
    ],
    resource in Entity::CustomerDocument
)
when {
    resource.customerId == context.customerId
};
```